

11

PAST SIMPLE TENSE

We use the past simple for actions that happened in the past. We often use past time expressions with the past simple.

Form

 Subject + Verb 2nd form + Object

Affirmatives

Subject

I/he/she/it/Ali/
we/you/they

Verb 2nd Form

played

Object

cricket.

Negatives

Subject

I/he/she/it/Ali/
we/you/they

Helping Verb+not

did not
(didn't)

Verb 1st Form

play

Object

cricket.



REMEMBER

 We use verb 2nd form only in affirmative sentences in Past simple tense.

Interrogatives

Helping Verb	Subject	Verb 1 st Form	Object+?
Did	I/he/she/it/Ali	play	cricket?
Did	we/you/they	play	cricket?

👉 yesterday

👉 last week

👉 yesterday morning

👉 in September

👉 yesterday afternoon

👉 two days ago

👉 last night

👉 in 1988.

Stative Verbs

The verb "to be" in past simple has two forms: **was** and **were** for states (=existence or condition of something or somebody).

Form

👉 Subject + was/ were + Extra words

Affirmatives

Subject	Stative Verb	Extra words
I / he/ she / it	was	ready.
We / you / they	were	ready.

Negatives

Subject	Stative Verb+not	Extra words
I / he / she / it	was not (wasn't)	ready.
We / you / they	were not (weren't)	ready.

Interrogatives

Stative Verb	Subject	Extra words+?
Was	I / he / she / it	ready?
Were	we / you / they	ready?

 I was here.

 Was he in the garden?

 You were right.

No, he wasn't.

 It wasn't difficult.

 Was I ready?

 They weren't late.

 Were we ready?

 Were you OK? Yes, I was.

Note Has and have indicate possession or relationships in the present while Had is used in the past.

Exercises

11.1

Circle the correct answer.

 They **was** / **were** here yesterday.

 Where **was** / **were** you?

-  The film **was** / **were** funny.
-  What **was** / **were** the weather like?
-  We **wasn't** / **weren't** hungry.
-  **Was** / **Were** Ali at school?
-  He **wasn't** / **weren't** a doctor.
-  **Was** / **Were** Ali and Sami there?
-  You **wasn't** / **weren't** at the cinema.

11.2

Write questions with **was** and **were** and short answers with **was**, **wasn't**, **were**, and **weren't**.

 You / at school

Were you at school yesterday?

No, I wasn't.

 It / cold

_____ yesterday?

 Your friends / happy

_____ yesterday?

 You / tired

_____ last night?

Past Simple: Regular Verbs

We form the 2nd form of regular verbs by adding -d, -ed or -ied to the verb. The 3rd form of verb, which will be discussed in a later chapter is also made in the similar way.

Verb 1 st Form	Verb 2 nd Form	Verb 3 rd Form
play	played	played
ask	asked	asked
start	started	started
wash	washed	washed
like	liked	liked
share	shared	shared
study	studied	studied
cry	cried	cried
travel	travelled	travelled
chat	chatted	chatted

 I **cleaned** my room yesterday.

 They **waited** for two hours.

Remember

We use **did or didn't** and the base form for **questions and negative** forms.

 I didn't enjoy the film.

 When did you start that book?

11.3 Write the verbs in the past simple.

Verb 1st Form	Verb 2 nd Form
visit	
rain	
learn	
call	
try	
miss	
drop	
cook	
receive	
study	

11.4

Complete the **affirmative** and **negative** past simple sentences and questions.

 I usually play tennis.

(+) Yesterday, I played football.

 We usually chat online.

(-) Yesterday, we _____ on the phone.

 Do you like the food today?

(?) _____ the food yesterday?

 He lives in this house now.

(+) He _____ in this house five years ago.

 My sister doesn't want to go.

(-) She _____ to go last week.

 Does it work now?

(?) _____ yesterday?

 I study Japanese.

(+) My aunt _____ Japanese in 1974.

11.5

Complete the questions with **was**, **were**, or **did**.

-  What did you watch on TV yesterday?
-  How _____ your weekend?
-  Where _____ you live in 2008?
-  _____ you study for any exams last month?
-  Where _____ you at four o'clock yesterday afternoon?
-  _____ a friend phone you yesterday?
-  Where _____ you born?
-  What _____ the weather like yesterday?
-  When _____ you start learning English?

11.6

Use the questions in exercise 11.5 to interview a partner.

What did you watch on TV yesterday?

I watched a film.

Past Simple: Irregular Verbs

Many verbs have irregular 2nd and 3rd form.

Verb 1 st Form	Verb 2 nd Form	Verb 3 rd Form
come	came	come
do	did	done
fall	fell	fallen
find	found	found
go	went	gone
have	had	had
put	put	put
ring	rang	rung
say	said	said
see	saw	seen
sit	sat	sat

11.7

Write the 2nd and 3rd forms of these verbs.

Verb 1 st Form	Verb 2 nd Form	Verb 3 rd Form
give		
leave		
swim		
cut		
run		
read		
drink		
hurt		
make		
hit		
buy		
sell		
teach		
fly		

Verb 1 st Form	Verb 2 nd Form	Verb 3 rd Form
meet		
eat		
lose		
sleep		
write		
come		
become		
keep		
think		
bring		
catch		
draw		
strike		
feel		

11.8

Complete the email with the **past simple** form of the verb in brackets.

Dear Grandpa,

How are you? I rang (ring) you yesterday but Grandma said you were in the garden.

Guess what? Sami _____ (come) to our house yesterday. He _____ (bring) a fish with him! He _____ (say) he _____ (catch) it in the river.

Mum cooked the fish and Dad _____ (make) a salad. We _____ (sit) in the garden. We all _____ (have) a fantastic evening.

See you soon.

Zain

11.9

Complete the conversations.

Did you drink my juice?

No, I drank my juice.

Did you sleep in a tent?

No, we _____ on the beach.

_____ a newspaper?

No, I had a magazine.

Did you meet Sofia?

No, I _____ Sarah.

_____ any birds?

No, but I saw some butterflies.

Did you have lunch?

Yes, I _____ a sandwich.